



TYPE/HITS	SPEED	TURNS	SHIELDS	ARMOUR	TURRETS
Escort/1	15 cm	45°	1	5+	1
ARMAMENT		RANGE/SPEED	FIREPOWER/STR		FIRE ARC
Dorsal weapons battery		15 cm	2		Left/front/right
SPECIAL	• Transports do not have the powerful drives routinely fitted to warships. Transports using <i>All Ahead Full</i> orders only add +3D6 cm to their speed. • They also reduce their randomly rolled Leadership by one, so they will have a Leadership value of between 5 and 8. • Transports have 'Special' for their points value as they are usually only used as objectives in missions or as fire ships for planetary defence purposes.				

Hundreds, perhaps thousands, of transport ships participated in the Gothic War. The vast majority were chartered merchantmen pressed into service to move war materials to systems under blockade, while many others were Imperial Navy support vessels used to resupply the fleet and form temporary repair bases in isolated systems. The crews of these small vessels, despite being untrained in the arts of battle, struggled valiantly against often impossible odds and paid a heavy price in blood for their efforts. Most transport ships carry some weapons to protect themselves against pirates and other raiders, but without decent sensors and fire control by experienced officers, the chances of getting a shot at the enemy is miniscule. One exception was the *Son of John*, a Tarask class merchant that was part of a convoy moving into Port Maw in the early part of the war. When the convoy came under attack by a Slaughter class Chaos cruiser that had slipped past the escort screen, the *Son of John* engaged the ship from close quarters and succeeded in distracting it for long enough for the other transports to escape. Its puny guns firing to the last, the Imperial vessel was destroyed, but its heroism and sacrifice shone like a beacon in the dark days that followed.